

Escalation Level	Trigger	Initial Owner	Escalate To	Example Scenarios	Required Response
Level 1 – Workstream Escalation	Day-to-day issue affecting an individual workstream but still manageable within the team	PM or functional lead	Head Developer or Operations Lead depending on issue	Minor build blocker, ticket confusion, test defect, missing workflow clarification	Resolve within workstream, document action item, confirm owner and due date
Level 2 – Cross-Functional Escalation	Issue affects multiple teams or threatens a weekly milestone	PM	Core project stakeholders (Head Developer, Operations, Sales as needed)	Integration issue delaying testing, onboarding workflow conflict, delayed deliverable affecting demo prep	Review in cross-functional checkpoint or ad hoc working session, assign corrective actions
Level 3 – Project-Level Escalation	Issue materially threatens timeline, executive approval, or client acceptance	PM	CEO / Executive Sponsor	Major integration failure, repeated missed milestone, demo readiness concern, major scope conflict	Escalate immediately with status summary, business impact, options, and recommendation
Level 4 – Client / Executive Decision Escalation	Issue requires strategic decision, approval, or client-facing alignment	PM / Executive Sponsor	CEO and/or Client Stakeholder	Client requests material change, internal approval withheld, scope decision affects rollout commitment	Conduct decision meeting, align on path forward, document decision and communication plan